

Project Management System - Core Objective & Concepts

1. The Main Idea

The goal of the platform is to manage both **Projects** and **Events** using the same workflow. Whether it's a software project, a college fest, a workshop, or a hackathon, the system should help plan the work, manage the team, track progress, and monitor finances.

Instead of building separate systems for projects and events, the platform should have a common structure where only the meaning of certain entities changes depending on the type of work.

2. Planning

Planning is where the entire project is structured before execution begins.

A Project/Event is divided into multiple **Departments** such as Development, Marketing, Logistics, Finance, Registration, etc.

Each Department is then divided into **Modules** (or Work Packages). Initially these were designed thinking only about software projects, but they don't actually represent software modules. They simply represent a logical grouping of work inside a department.

For example, in a software project:

Development

- Authentication
- Dashboard
- Payment System

In an event:

Marketing

- Social Media
- Posters
- Sponsorship Promotion

Logistics

- Venue

- Food
- Transport

So the hierarchy always remains:

Project/Event → Department → Module (Work Package) → Tasks

The only thing that changes is what the module represents.

3. Tasks

Tasks are the smallest unit of work.

Every module contains multiple tasks which are assigned to members and tracked until completion.

For example,

Development → Authentication → Design Login UI → JWT Authentication API → Forgot Password Flow

or

Marketing → Social Media → Design Instagram Post → Schedule Posts → Publish Reel

This structure works for every kind of project.

4. Timeline & Milestones

The project has a predefined **Start Date** and **End Date**.

Once these dates are decided, the manager creates milestones throughout the timeline.

For example,

Project Starts

↓

Requirements Approved

↓

Prototype Ready

↓

Beta Release

↓

Final Delivery

or for an event,

Planning Complete

↓

Sponsors Confirmed

↓

Registrations Open

↓

Venue Ready

↓

Event Day

↓

Event Completed

Milestones are checkpoints on the timeline.

They are **not tied to departments**.

Instead, tasks from different departments contribute towards the same milestone.

For example,

Milestone: "Prototype Ready"

Development contributes backend tasks.

Design contributes UI tasks.

Testing contributes initial testing tasks.

When all these tasks are completed, the milestone is achieved.

This allows the timeline to represent the overall progress of the project instead of individual department progress.

5. Teams

The Teams section is purely for planning the people working on the project.

Members are invited, assigned roles, and attached to one or more departments.

Every member can also have a **Monthly Cost**.

This monthly cost is **not an expense**.

It is simply a commitment.

For example,

John

₹20,000/month

Project Duration

6 Months

Committed Cost

₹1,20,000

This helps estimate whether the project budget is sufficient before spending any money.

6. Budget Planning

The project has an overall budget.

Example:

Project Budget

₹25,000

This budget is then distributed across departments.

Marketing

₹8,000

Development

₹10,000

Logistics

₹6,000

Remaining Buffer

₹1,000

Notice that no money has actually been spent.

This is only planning.

The budget simply defines how much each department is allowed to utilize.

7. Revenue

Revenue represents every source of money entering the project.

Examples include:

- Investments
- Sponsors
- Grants
- Donations
- Client Payments
- Ticket Sales
- Registration Fees
- Merchandise Sales
- Vendor Income
- Refunds
- Other Income

Revenue tells us how much money has come into the project.

It has nothing to do with budget allocation.

8. Expenses

Expenses represent actual money leaving the project.

These can include:

- Venue Booking
- Equipment
- Printing
- Food
- Travel
- Marketing
- Software Licenses
- Logistics
- Miscellaneous Expenses

Expenses should follow a proper workflow.

Expense Request

↓

Approval / Rejection

↓

Payment

↓

Recorded as Actual Expense

This ensures proper financial control.

9. Payroll

The monthly cost of members should remain inside the Teams section because it is only a planned commitment.

Once a month actually passes and members are paid, those payments become **Payroll Expenses**.

For example,

John

Monthly Cost

₹20,000

This remains a commitment until payment is made.

When salary is paid,

Expense

Category: Payroll

Paid To: John

Amount: ₹20,000

Now it becomes an actual expense.

This keeps planning and accounting separate.

10. Finance

Finance combines Revenue and Expenses.

It answers questions like:

How much income has been received?

How much has actually been spent?

How much cash is currently available?

This is different from the planning budget.

For example,

Budget

₹25,000

Committed Team Cost

₹24,000

Income Received

₹30,000

Expenses Paid

₹12,000

Current Cash Balance

₹18,000

Here,

Budget is planning.

Committed Cost is expected manpower expenditure.

Income and Expenses represent real cash movement.

These should never be mixed together.

11. Progress Tracking

Progress should not be measured by money.

Progress is measured through completed work.

Departments complete Tasks.

Tasks contribute to Milestones.

Milestones move along the Timeline.

The Timeline then shows the overall completion of the project.

So each module of the platform answers a different question:

Planning: How is the work organized?

Timeline: When should the work be completed?

Teams: Who is working on it and what is the expected manpower cost?

Revenue: Where is the money coming from?

Expenses: Where is the money actually being spent?

Finance: What is the current financial position?

Progress: How much of the project has actually been completed?

By keeping these concepts separate, the platform remains flexible enough to manage software projects, events, workshops, hackathons, or any other collaborative work using the same underlying structure.